

Kirill Lebedev, PhD

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Summary

A results-driven Director of Engineering who has built and scaled multiple high-impact advertising solutions from 0 to 1, including bootstrapping the Brand Advertising business line to over \$1B in annual revenue and drove AI ads solution to \$100M ARR in just six months. An expert in leading and motivating diverse, full-stack (UI, Backend, Data, AI) teams within a highly collaborative culture. Adept at championing grassroots innovation, securing executive buy-in, and uniting cross-functional partners to transform ideas into globally adopted products. A seasoned AI leader with deep experience integrating sophisticated AI/ML models into large-scale, client-facing solutions. A consistent innovator, as evidenced by multiple patents and successful product launches.

Professional Experience

[LinkedIn](#) | [San Francisco Bay Area](#) | 2016 - Present

Director of Engineering (Mar 2024 - Present)

- As the overall **Ads Measurement leader**: strategically revamped the outcomes infrastructure (consolidating signals to deliver **significant accuracy improvements, reduce differential privacy noise, and ensure robust privacy compliance**); championed B2B company-level measurement (across \$3B in spend) that validated a **2x incremental spend increase** for adopters; and innovated the core incrementality solution with Bayesian calculation, company-level audience split, and frequency-aware sampling.
- Own the complete strategy—including business, technology, hiring, and compensation - for a 40-70+ person full-stack organization responsible for **Audience, Identity, Incrementality, Recommendations, and Measurement**. Full ownership includes performance management, hardware budget planning, defining the team's mission and success metrics, and redesigning the org structure to align with long-term business goals including **AI-native developer transformation** and **2X AI productivity boost**.
- Served as the Engineering DRI (Directly Responsible Individual) and key decision-maker for AI Ads Audience products, a major cross-organizational initiative to build LinkedIn's AI-powered ads solution. Lead a collaborative XFn team—including Product, Design, DS, PMM, and a Sales tiger team - through daily execution to define and deliver the engineering strategy for AI targeting, creative generation, and performance measurement, driving 6x growth to **\$100M ARR** within six months.
- Accountable for the organization's bi-annual business planning, weekly performance reviews, and all resource allocation. Present weekly OKR progress and business updates directly to the executive team and serve as the **engineering representative in M&A strategy** sessions.
- Drove multiple "0-to-1" product innovations, including **Conversion Lift** testing and a company-wide hackathon-winning GAI video ad generation concept. Led the strategic overhaul of LinkedIn's **Ads interest modeling**, rebuilding the core ML models from the ground up to significantly improve audience targeting precision, and led the critical Identity/Audience infrastructure migration to a new tech stack.
- Lead a senior leadership team of managers and 3+ Sr Staff Engineers; established a sustainable craft upleveling program with mentorship and architectural reviews. Serve on the company-wide hiring committee for Apps/UI talent.

Senior Engineering Manager (Sep 2020 - Mar 2024)

- Bootstrapped the Brand Advertising business line from the ground up, championing a grassroots initiative that grew into a business generating over \$1B annually (~20% of total ad revenue). Led the creation of the end-to-end product suite, including AI-powered optimization (Reach & Frequency), Brand Lift measurement, and a new Media Planning tool, unlocking expansion into CTV and live events.
- Drove major strategic data initiatives, partnering with BizDev to redefine **3rd-party incrementality measurement with Nielsen, Kantar, and Dynata**, scaling it to \$500M with a privacy-first, AI-driven solution. Also partnered with FP&A to build the company-wide business forecasting platform now used for the CEO's daily report.
- Scaled a full-stack organization from 18 to 40** by creating a two-layer management structure and promoting key leaders. Drove engineering excellence initiatives that reduced bug introduction by 75% and alert volume by 70%.

Engineering Manager (Jul 2018 - Sep 2020)

- Pioneered and launched the company's first **advertiser-facing A/B testing platform** from the ground up, collaborating with Data Science, Product, and Design to deliver a GA product that improved advertiser ROI by an average of 40% on tested campaigns.

Education

Doctor of Philosophy (PhD), Computer Science | 2004 - 2008 Irkutsk National Research Technical University

- Thesis**: Development of a method and tools for creating applications for a website content management system.
- Master of Engineering, Computer Science** (Diploma with Distinction) | 1999 - 2004 Irkutsk National Research Technical University

Patents

- On-Device Experimentation** (US 11,968,185), Issued April 2024
- Editing Mechanism for Electronic Content Items** (US 11,232,254), Issued January 2022
- Content Item Similarity Detection** (US 11,102,534), Issued August 2021

- Took ownership of the ads forecasting team and its scope, expanding it from 5 to 15 full-stack engineers. Redesigned the team's charter to create and launch a new AI-driven advertiser recommendations product, establishing a business area that generates ~\$20M in incremental annual revenue from SMB advertisers and has achieved sustained 2-3x YoY growth in recommendation acceptance and views for the last 7 years. Mentored and promoted multiple engineers to the Staff level.

Staff Software Engineer (2016 - 2018)

- Architected and delivered the first ML-powered system for automated ad content review, a critical initiative for scaling the ads business while maintaining platform integrity. This system reduced manual review workload by 90% and, by incorporating a direct user feedback loop, improved member trust metrics by cutting ad-related escalations by 80%.

Chief Software Engineer | Organizer Inc. | San Francisco Bay Area | Nov 2012 - Jul 2016

- Led the end-to-end design and implementation of a real-time political canvassing system, including mobile clients (Android/iOS), a GWT web console, and a Google Cloud backend with a BigQuery analytics platform.
- Delivered a comprehensive tool for real-time workforce tracking, phone banking, voter targeting, and survey analysis.
- Ensured 24/7 system reliability for high-profile political campaigns across the US, including the Ed Lee SF mayoral and parts of the 2016 Hillary Clinton presidential campaigns.
- Managed engineering craft for a team of 15+ onsite and offshore engineers, reducing the bug introduction rate by 80% through a redefined quality control and automated testing strategy.

Co-Founder & CTO | i.Point LLC | Irkutsk, Russia | Jan 2002 - Nov 2021

- Hired and scaled the engineering organization to 20+ professionals, establishing the company's software development lifecycle, performance metrics, and onboarding processes.
- Led technical strategy and architecture, collaborating with external partners and serving as the technical lead for the successful delivery of 10+ major client projects.
- Managed all technical operations for the company, including technology budgeting and hardware provisioning.

Deputy Vice-Rector / Instructor | Irkutsk National Research Technical University | Irkutsk, Russia | Sep 2004 - Jan 2012

- Managed the university's Internet Technology Center, overseeing all team operations (hiring, performance, quality control), building an online learning system (300+ courses), and leading the university website team through 3 full redesigns and 2 infrastructure migrations.
- Taught undergraduate courses: Software Engineering, Operating Systems, and Statistics & Probability Theory.

Areas of Expertise

- **Executive Leadership & Strategy:** Organizational Design & Scaling (70+), Business & Technology Strategy, Financial & Budget Management, Executive Communication, M&A Technical Evaluation.
- **AdTech Product Incubation (0 to 1):** Brand Advertising, AI-Powered Advertising Product Suite (LinkedIn Accelerate), Media Planning, Advertiser Recommendations, A/B Testing & Incrementality Platforms.
- **AI/ML Productization:** Applied AI & ML Strategy, Forecasting Models, AI-based Targeting & Retrieval, Privacy-First AI Solutions.
- **Technology & Architecture:** Cloud-Native Architecture, Distributed Systems, Full-Stack Web and Mobile Application Development (Consumer & Enterprise), ML Platform & Infrastructure, Operational Excellence.